

Dynasty Chronicle

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THE PEOPLE VS. MARCUS RETHWISCH

The Dynasty is Going to Court.

Cover Story: A Dynasty in Question

The events of the past 24 hours, no matter their eventual outcome, will undoubtedly echo for years in the minds and hearts of this league. One could not have written a more seductively ludicrous day for the ED if they had kidnapped Stephen King, given him LSD, and forced him at gunpoint to write an erotica prequel to “It”. Kyle O’Keefe, coming off a sub-100 point performance in week 1, went full San Andreas and sent shockwaves through that great geological fortress we call the ED Narrative. O’Keefe, as if between drags of a Virginia Slim at a Parisian espresso bar, ever-so-casually alleged that Marcus Rethwisch had acquired Christian McCaffrey from his in 2018 with the help of a bass guitar amp. The league trembled in disbelief; what seemed like a humorous misrepresentation of a complex, league-altering trade from years ago quickly devolved into a sobering discussion surrounding the validity of O’Keefe’s claims. Intrigue and confusion swelled in the early morning hours as league members began to see the calamity that faced them should these events be as described.

Kyle O’Keefe’s telling of these events represent what could be a monumental paradigm shift for this league. Though the implications are near impossible to quantify, the question must be asked...is Rethwisch’s dynasty and 3-peat a product of impropriety? If so, some may argue the validity of the reset. Other factors that may be called into question include the rise and fall of Todd Jacobs, the outcome of the 2018 playoffs and championship, and the entire 2019 season, where Marcus enjoyed the spoils of fantasy glory at the hands of McCaffrey. In wanting to give a voice to O’Keefe, the Chronicle was given exclusive right to publish his statement of events, which reads as follows:

“I remember it was a cold and lonely time in November in Carlsbad. It hadn’t been that long that I felt like I really planted my feet here in San Diego and was still trying desperately to make friends and put myself out there. I had just been through a tough job change, moving to a new house, along with several other normal growing pains of life. To say one of those things wasn’t a financial struggle would be a lie. Over the several weeks prior, Marcus had made it apparent that he was interested in CMC very early on in the season, and after repeated attempts to acquire him, I thought he had finally moved on when I told him “it’s not gonna happen man. You just don’t have the pieces I want or need right now.” He seemed defeated, but deep down, I knew this wasn’t the end of this battle. The morning before the trade was auto-blasted to our emails via ESPN, shaking the very ground our league was built upon, I decided to go to the Mission Church at Ada Harris to interact with some people I haven’t seen in a while, Marcus being one of them. Marcus was playing bass that morning. After the service, we were having our typical “stand in a circle and take turns talking about how bad each other is at fantasy” conversations. As the morning started to wrap up, I approached Marcus. “Hey, would you be willing to sell one of your amps to me? I’ve been getting gig offers but I can’t say yes because I don’t have an amp.” A smirk slowly came across his face. “Absolutely. Let’s talk later today” That afternoon, a very long exchange of texts was underway. “I could sell this to you for \$100... but I don’t want your money. I want CMC.” I’d be lying if I said this wasn’t intriguing at the least. “What do you mean?” I asked. “Look, I know money is tight now. I’d be happy to have you take this amp off my hands at no financial loss... you just got give me CMC. Obviously, I’ll give you players too.” Frankly, the details of the conversation are hard to remember. But I do know the theme was “I’ll give you an asset that creates opportunity.” He wasn’t wrong. Was losing a few more game and a shot to my ego with the guys in my league worth an amp that would mean I can start saying “yes” to more gigs, in turn making my money situation a little easier? It was quickly revealed that the answer was yes. I needed to set my pride aside and do what, at the time, I thought was the right thing for myself. I knew I would be scrutinized, but in that moment, I was okay with that. Marcus and I came to terms. I went and picked up the amp that night from his house, where he hugged me and assured me “you did the right thing.” He also mentioned that it would make me look bad to know I accepted a gift like this, and took it without thinking about the lasting impact of the league. I believe the term for what Marcus did is Gaslighting, but I digress. A few weeks later, when I had been through day after day of shame from my friends in the league, I became sad at my decision. “Maybe we shouldn’t have done this” I text Marcus. “I didn’t realize how mad this would make everyone, and I’m tired of being called a moron.” I sat with my thoughts, in my shame for being “trade raped”, and kept saying “I feel like if tell them about the amp, they’ll understand why I did it.” But the thought of the aftershock with Marcus was too much for me. I knew it would still be spun against me, and I’d look like more of a fool. The real shame sunk in a couple weeks later, when Marcus told me how foolish and stupid I was for accepting his offer. “I was going to give you the amp anyways for free” he laughed. “It’s just too easy. Thanks for the championship.” I couldn’t think of another time I felt so taken advantage of. He took my financial state and used it as a weapon against me... and in that, there is no honor. In that, there is no true champion.

In closing, I need to take responsibility for my actions. I put my own personal gain over the longevity and integrity of the league, and I sincerely do apologize. Even though I was not aware of the rule in place, I did know that my moral compass was against it, but I still took the amp because of what having it for free meant to me. It truly has helped me make money in the past several years, and that money has gotten me out of some tough situations. This is not meant to be an excuse, or me pulling at heart strings, but rather the reality of the situation. Again, I sincerely apologize that I put my interests above yours. However, it's very clear Marcus did know this was against League Policy, and he did it anyways to further his reign as the most dominant manager in ED history, and to him, I apologize that my remarks and remembrance of his past actions will likely change the way his incredible run, and ultimately, his remarkable dynasty run shook all of us to our core and made us question our own abilities at fantasy football."

Rethwisch played defense for most of the morning as league members piled on questions and accusations of fraud. The possibility of major retribution became heavy in the air as the ED Slack channel contained its heaviest traffic since the height of the Kamaragate scandal. Once the controversy seemed to reach a fever pitch, it became clear that legal arbitration was going to be utilized, and Rethwisch was quick on the offensive to procure Jordan Menard to be his legal defense for an undisclosed compensation package.



Menard beamed with confidence regarding the innocence of his new client. A statement was released from “the desk of Marcus Rethwisch” that drew concern and questions of authorship from the league. Menard was firm yet cordial while addressing concerns from the rest of the league. Shortly thereafter, it was decided that Cal Roberts and Cody Scheiwe would be teaming up to prosecute Rethwisch. The two have never formally worked together but seem to be a promising duo in taking on the legal behemoth of prosecuting the league’s most decorated participant.

What’s at stake in all of this? Rumors have been circulating about removing Rethwisch’s name from the trophy, melting his championship rings, among other more penal alternatives that I don’t care to put into print. Though much is at stake for Rethwisch, he is in good legal hands with Menard, who ironically was his fiercest critic before going on the payroll. Menard may have signed on for some serious fantasy-related incentives, should he get Marcus a non-guilty ruling. He will have his work cut out for him as he defends the league’s most controversial winner to a jury of Isaac Williams, Mason Burns, Carter Roberts, and Noah May. Early polling suggests this jury will lean in favor of the prosecution, but it is simply too early to tell. One thing is certain, the ED will enact its own strange form of justice, and whether he is found guilty or not, Rethwisch’s standing in the league is officially on the wrong side of history. Time will tell if he is able to reclaim goodwill amongst his competitors.

Drew Gilmore – Managing Editor

Week 1 Headlines at a Glance:

Scheiwe Cleared of Fraud Charges

SEC Claims Stating Information That Everyone Knows Not a Big Deal

Burns on Jury Selection: “I Wanna See that \$%#@ Burn”

Victims’ Rights Advocates Outraged at Blatant Bias

League Office in Talks with truTV Hit “Operation Repo”

Commissioner Says They Need Professionals to Repossess Rethwisch’s Paraphernalia

O’Keefe Admitted to Safehouse in Lakeside

Rethwisch’s Bullying Messages Seen as Indicator of Inevitable Violence

May on CMC Scandal: “I Feel Like my Team is Built on a Burial Ground”

An Exploration of the Long-Lasting Effects of Fantasy Fraud

League Trip to Raiders Game Postponed to 2026

League Office Estimates \$50k Deficit from Rethwisch Case

ED’s TikTok Generation Reportedly Uninterested in Rethwisch Case

Roberts and Williams Silent on Leagues’ Most Desperate Day